canted nozzle was designed to deflect the jet away from the aircraft. We conducted the first static test of RATO in the twelfth month of the project initiation. Within the next four months, we conducted 64 static tests. And we were just about 20 engineers working on the project!

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Movers

The future satel ite launch vehicle (SLV) had also been conceived by this time. Recognising the immense socio-economic benefits of space technology, Prof. Sarabhai decided in 1969, to go ful -steam ahead with the task of establishing indigenous capability in building and launching our own satel ites. He personal y participated in an aerial survey of the east coast for a possible site for launching satel ite launch vehicles and large rockets.

Prof. Sarabhai was concentrating on the east coast in order to let the launch vehicle take ful advantage of the earth’s west to east rotation. He final y selected the Sriharikota island, 100 km north of Madras (now Chennai), and thus the SHAR Rocket Launch Station was born. The crescent-shaped island has a maximum width of 8 km and